



Erica Gatts

DESIGN STRATEGIST

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Profile

Human-centered design leader with 14+ years of experience in product and service design, user research, and design strategy—specializing in healthcare and complex enterprise systems.

I drive research-led strategy, design systems, and stakeholder alignment across complex initiatives including precision oncology, behavioral health, Medicare decision-support, radiology workflows, and consumer financial products—simplifying complexity to deliver measurable adoption, satisfaction, and better outcomes. My mission is to design products and services that empower people to live healthier lives.

Employment History

Senior Manager, Experience Design, Foundation Medicine, Boston, MA

Dec 2021 — Present

Lead a cross-functional design team to create patient- and clinician-facing experiences that translate comprehensive genomic profiling into actionable clinical insights.

- Set UX strategy and design systems for diagnostic reports, clinician portals, and patient education—improving clarity of clinical interpretation and usability across care teams.
- Collaborate with oncologists, geneticists, product managers, and engineers to prioritize features, conduct user research, and iterate prototypes that accelerate clinical decision-making.
- Implement research-driven design processes and metrics to evaluate comprehension, adoption, and satisfaction, enabling data-informed product decisions.
- Mentor and develop designers and researchers, fostering cross-functional alignment and continuous improvement.

Lead Design Strategist, Highmark Health, Pittsburgh

Jan 2019 — Nov 2021

Led research and design strategy for enterprise initiatives focused on improving patient and clinical experiences, with emphasis on behavioral health and senior benefits navigation.

- Directed discovery research that shaped Highmark's enterprise behavioral health strategy by identifying unmet needs and informing roadmap priorities.
- Conceptualized and prototyped a Medicare decision-support product for seniors—defining personas, journeys, and value propositions to simplify coverage selection.
- Collaborated with cross-functional stakeholders to translate insights into product requirements and measurable success metrics.

Senior Experience Designer, PNC Bank, Pittsburgh, PA

Feb 2017 — Jan 2019

Portfolio & Profile Links

[Portfolio \(password: 1565\)](#)

[LinkedIn](#)

Skills

Design Strategy

Design Leadership

User Experience Design

Service Design

Product Design

Product Strategy

User Research

Design Storytelling

Content Strategy

UX Writing

Stakeholder Engagement

Cross-Functional Collaboration

Insights Development

Business Needs Alignment

Simplifying Complexity

Strategic Alignment

Design Prototyping

Wireframing & Prototyping

Led research and design within PNC's Innovation Department, conducting ethnographic, discovery, and usability studies to inform product strategy and service design.

- Conducted ethnographic research and stakeholder interviews to surface the needs of micro-business owners and identify service opportunities.
- Ran usability and concept tests for personal lending initiatives to improve user flows and reduce friction.
- Designed concepts and recommended product changes that streamlined banker onboarding and relationship-building with new corporate customers.

Lead Designer, UPMC Enterprises + GE Healthcare, Pittsburgh, PA

Aug 2014 — Sept 2016

Led the design team for UPMC's strategic partnership with GE Healthcare, overseeing research, design, and implementation for GE's radiology software across UPMC's footprint.

- Directed user research and prototyping to align the product with clinical workflows and regulatory requirements.
- Partnered with engineering and clinical stakeholders to support deployment, adoption, and design QA across sites.

Senior User Experience Designer, athenahealth, Watertown, MA

Jul 2013 — Aug 2014

User experience design for athenahealth's "Best in KLAS" Patient Portal and Communicator products. Leading and coordinating UX design efforts for a patient-centered project focused on population health management and preventive care.

Senior User Experience Designer, Autodesk, Waltham, MA

Jun 2011 — Aug 2013

Led UX design and research for Revit, Autodesk's building information modeling (BIM) software, contributing to interaction designs and visualizations that supported complex design workflows.

- Facilitated design research and developed information visualizations and communication materials to explore future BIM capabilities.
- Contributed to product concepts and interaction designs that improved information clarity for architects and engineers; role began as a summer internship in 2011 and transitioned to full-time responsibilities.

Education

Master of Design, Communication Planning and Information Design, Carnegie Mellon University, Pittsburgh, PA

Aug 2010 — May 2012

Graduated with 4.1 GPA. Master's thesis explored digital and service design strategies to inform Pennsylvania policymakers about the importance of Head Start in shaping early childhood development.